NCCP 00586 · VERSION 3

Capecitabine + radiotherapy

Capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–5 of each 7-day cycle, alongside radiotherapy, for up to 5–6 cycles. Follow the written plan for treatment days and interruptions.

Draft for clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Mouth

Capecitabine

Painful ulcers or reduced intake: stop tablets and call.

2 Chest

Capecitabine

New chest pain: stop tablets and seek urgent assessment.

3 Bowel / stoma

Capecitabine + radiotherapy

Significant diarrhoea, increased output or dehydration needs prompt advice.

4 Hands / feet

Capecitabine

Pain or peeling affecting daily activity: stop tablets and call.

5 Blood / infection

Capecitabine

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

6 Hydration / urine

Capecitabine safety

Reduced urine, dizziness or inability to drink needs assessment.

7 Pelvic skin

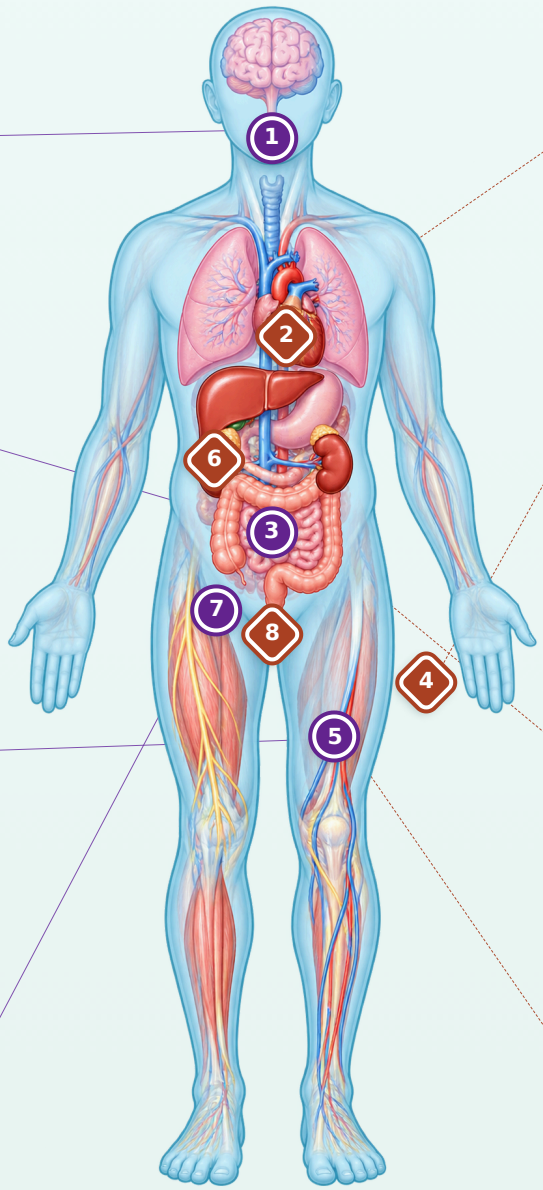
Radiotherapy

Report painful, broken or weeping skin in the treatment area.

8 Bladder / sexual health

Radiotherapy

Report urinary pain and discuss fertility and sexual effects.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

NCCP 00586 · PRACTICAL SUPPORT

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Capecitabine

- Diarrhoea and dehydration
- Painful hands / feet
- Mouth soreness and reduced intake
- Low blood counts / serious infection
- Chest pain / heart problems
- Severe early toxicity, including DPD-related toxicity

Pelvic radiotherapy

- Bowel irritation / diarrhoea
- Pelvic skin soreness
- Urinary symptoms
- Fatigue
- Possible lasting bowel / bladder effects
- Sexual function / fertility effects

Chemo and radiotherapy are given together. See the treatment-course graphic or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Written tablet instructions

Ask for the number of each tablet strength per dose, the start and stop days, and the contact number. This page does not calculate a personal dose.

Missed or vomited dose

Skip that dose; take the next scheduled dose at its usual time unless the team has told you to stop. Never double up. Record missed doses and report repeated vomiting.

Skin, mouth and bowel care

Use the agreed skin and mouth-care plan. Keep your prescribed anti-sickness and diarrhoea medicines available. Significant symptoms still require stopping tablets and calling.

Checks and medicine review

Confirm DPD testing and regular blood tests. Tell the team about warfarin, phenytoin, allopurinol, brivudine and any new medicines or supplements. These need an interaction check.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00586/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.